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STEM OPT Extension

Jump to a Section

What Is a STEM OPT Extension?

The STEM OPT Extension is a work authorization for F-1 students who have graduated from an approved STEM field in the United States. As such, students must maintain their F-1 status and continue to report to OIS.

Students currently on Post-Completion OPT can apply for a STEM OPT Extension to extend their current work authorization for an additional 24 months. Employment must be directly related to the student's STEM degree.

The STEM OPT Extension Application will req tension I-20) from OIS before filing a formal application (F

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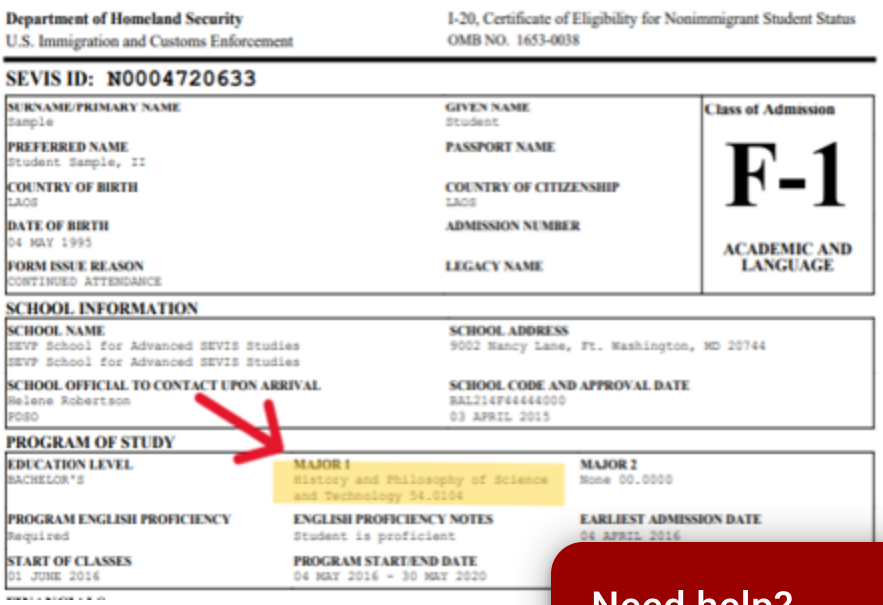
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institution.* Students can determine whether their degree program is STEM-designated by checking whether the CIP code on page 1 of their Form I-20 appears in the U.S. Department of Homeland Security's list of STEM-designated programs.



Department of Homeland Security
U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement

I-20, Certificate of Eligibility for Nonimmigrant Student Status
OMB NO. 1653-0038

SEVIS ID: N0004720633

SURNAME/PRIMARY NAME: Sample	GIVEN NAME: Student	Class of Admission: F-1
PREFERRED NAME: Student Sample, II	PASSPORT NAME	
COUNTRY OF BIRTH: LAOS	COUNTRY OF CITIZENSHIP: LAOS	
DATE OF BIRTH: 04 MAY 1995	ADMISSION NUMBER	
FORM ISSUE REASON: CONTINUED ATTENDANCE	LEGACY NAME	ACADEMIC AND LANGUAGE

SCHOOL INFORMATION

SCHOOL NAME: SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies SEVP School for Advanced SEVIS Studies	SCHOOL ADDRESS: 9002 Nancy Lane, Ft. Washington, MD 20744
SCHOOL OFFICIAL TO CONTACT UPON ARRIVAL: Helene Robertson PDSO	SCHOOL CODE AND APPROVAL DATE: BAL214F44444000 03 APRIL 2015

PROGRAM OF STUDY

EDUCATION LEVEL: BACHELOR'S	MAJOR 1: History and Philosophy of Science and Technology 54.0104	MAJOR 2: None 00.0000
PROGRAM ENGLISH PROFICIENCY: Required	ENGLISH PROFICIENCY NOTES: Student is proficient	EARLIEST ADMISSION DATE: 04 APRIL 2016
START OF CLASSES: 01 JUNE 2016	PROGRAM START/END DATE: 04 MAY 2016 - 30 MAY 2020	

Your degree program's CIP code can be found[illegible] Study" section on your Form I-20.

*Students who have completed a STEM-desi[illegible] attended program may be eligible to apply for the STE[illegible] our page on [illegible]g a STEM OPT Extension based on a pri[illegible]

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Completing the Form I-983

The "Form I-983 Training Plan for STEM OPT Students" is a document that clearly articulates the student's learning objectives and affirms the employer's commitment to helping the student achieve those objectives.

Students can download the Form I-983 from the USCIS website. Students and their employers must complete and sign Form I-983 before students can request their STEM OPT Extension I-20 from OIS.

Refer to our sample Form I-983 for USC graduates for guidance on completing the form correctly. Additional guidance on Form I-983 requirements is available on the Study in the States website. Only use the most up-to-date sample I-983 provided on this page. Please do not use any previous versions of the sample I-983 found in search engine results.

Tip: Print the Form I-983 to a PDF and save it ed version to the STEM OPT Extension I-20 Request in Troja

Students should submit the completed Form TEM OPT sion I-20 Request in Trojan International

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How to Request a STEM OPT Extension I-20 from OIS

Receiving the STEM OPT Extension I-20 from OIS

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Filing the Form I-765

After receiving the STEM OPT Extension I-20 from OIS, students must file Form I-765 online via their myUSCIS account.

Important Deadline Considerations

Before You File

How to File the Form I-765

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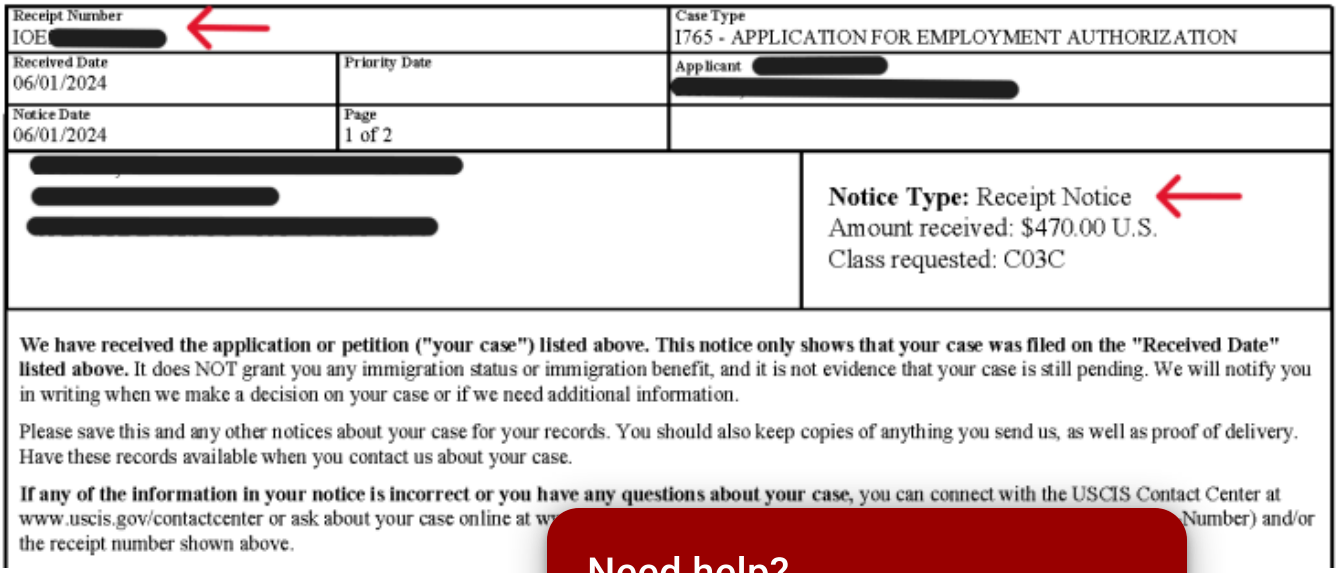
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After filing Form I-765 online with the supporting documents and filing fee, students will be issued the "I-797C Notice of Action: Receipt." This includes a receipt number, which they can use to check their case status.



Receipt Number		Case Type
IOE[redacted]		I765 - APPLICATION FOR EMPLOYMENT AUTHORIZATION
Received Date 06/01/2024	Priority Date	Applicant [redacted]
Notice Date 06/01/2024	Page 1 of 2	

[redacted]

Notice Type: Receipt Notice
Amount received: $470.00 U.S.
Class requested: C03C

We have received the application or petition ("your case") listed above. This notice only shows that your case was filed on the "Received Date" listed above. It does NOT grant you any immigration status or immigration benefit, and it is not evidence that your case is still pending. We will notify you in writing when we make a decision on your case or if we need additional information.

Please save this and any other notices about your case for your records. You should also keep copies of anything you send us, as well as proof of delivery. Have these records available when you contact us about your case.

If any of the information in your notice is incorrect or you have any questions about your case, you can connect with the USCIS Contact Center at www.uscis.gov/contactcenter or ask about your case online at w[redacted]Number) and/or the receipt number shown above.

Here is where to find your receipt number on [redacted] your case status.

Students may check current estimated proce[redacted]-765, then choose the appropriate form category and p[redacted]ce.

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Maintaining F-1 Status While on STEM OPT Extension

General STEM OPT Requirements

Unemployment

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STEM OPT Reporting Requir

While on STEM OPT Extension, students are r ent-related information to OIS via Trojan International w he following ements may result in the automatic te EVP and/or USCIS.

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Options for F-1 Students After STEM OPT Extension Ends

Once students reach the end of their STEM OPT Extension authorization period, they will have a 60-day grace period to remain in the United States and prepare for one of the following next steps.

New Program of Study at USC

Transfer to Another Institution

Depart the United States

Change of Status

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How do students report a change of address to USCIS and OIS if they move while their STEM OPT Extension application is pending?

Does USCIS accept students' electronic signatures on I-20s?

Can a student remain in the United States if their application is pending?

Can students file a STEM OPT Extension application with USCIS while they are abroad?

Can students with a pending STEM OPT Extension application continue working?

Can students travel while their STEM OPT [illegible] If so, what documents do the students need?

Can students cancel their STEM OPT Exten[illegible]

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My EAD got lost or stolen. What should I do?

What time zone does USCIS use for the I-765 filing deadline?

I logged in to my USCIS account to check the status of my pending STEM OPT Extension application, and under the "myProgress" tab, it says the estimated decision time is nine months. Is this accurate?

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Related Pages

Optional Practical Training

Post-Completion OPT

STEM OPT Extension Based on a Prior Degree

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